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Submitter Information

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General Comment

My name is Lexi Mannion, and I am a graduating senior from Avonworth High School. My academic focus has included an in-depth study of Generative AI and its societal implications. In particular, I dedicated two months to researching the application of AI within early childhood education for my AI and Ethics course. My findings suggest that the current administration's approach to AI regulation strikes a necessary balance between fostering innovation and ensuring responsible implementation. I believe that AI holds significant potential to enhance educational outcomes. In specific scenarios, it can provide valuable support to educators while simultaneously cultivating essential digital literacy, creativity, and problem-solving skills in children. As Adriene Shannon articulates in her work on AI in ECE, "If Aidan recognizes that Tommy is struggling with math, but excelling in language, Aidan can prompt math and language activities at different paces." This demonstrates AI's capacity to leverage data analysis for personalized learning, catering to individual learning styles, paces, and interests. While the integration of AI is inevitable, U.S. legislation must evolve to keep pace with rapid technological advancements. The Kids Online Safety Act, initially proposed in 2021, aims to protect minors' data on social media platforms. However, it does not address the data collection practices of web service providers and educational institutions. If schools decide to integrate AI into the curriculum, ongoing dialogue should bring families together with schools so everyone can help children benefit from AI while minimizing its potential harm. While AI offers substantial benefits in education, innovation and regulation need to be balanced. In essence, AI offers tremendous potential to enhance educational experiences, but we must approach its integration with a thoughtful and balanced perspective, ensuring that innovation is guided by responsible regulation and ethical considerations.